

THE WORKFLOW (USING CHATGPT)

- 1

Generate the prompt. In the Dashboard, pick the **Surface Patterns — Spoonflower** niche, set the generator to ChatGPT/DALL·E, add your style, collection name & vision, then Generate. Prompts are written for seamless repeats.
- 2

(Optional) Prompt Player. Load the prompts CSV to copy each prompt one at a time.
- 3

Make the tile in ChatGPT. Generate a **square** image — you'll get **1024×1024**. Ask for a "seamless repeating tile," and regenerate if any motif is clipped awkwardly at an edge.
- 4

Check your size math. At 150 DPI a 1024px tile is crisp to ~6.8". Largest repeat ≤6"? skip to step 6. Bigger? do step 5 first.
- 5

Export once, then inspect for softness. Any file tagged **_UPSCALED** (8/12/18/24" from a 1024px tile) was enlarged and looks softer — the tool warns you which. If those are too soft, enlarge the tile *properly* first:
- △ Fixing soft (upscaled) tiles — never upscale the raw tile, it breaks the seam

3×3 (safest): tile 9 copies (3072×3072 for a 1024 tile) → Upscayl at 4× → crop the **centre cell** (4096×4096, ≈27" @150). Every edge is upscaled with matching pattern around it, so it stays seamless.

2×2 (lighter): 4 copies (2048×2048) → 4× → crop a tile from the **centre**. Then re-drop & re-export — those sizes are now native, not _UPSCALED.
- 6

Export fabric-ready tiles. Drop the tile in the **1:1 (Square)** box → set **Output DPI** (150 for Spoonflower, 300 for printers that prefer it) → **Export Spoonflower tiles (ZIP)**. Seamless sRGB PNGs, 2–24".
- 7

Upload to your service. Pick the size, choose the repeat type, and **always check the repeat preview for seams** before ordering a swatch.

FILE REQUIREMENTS BY SERVICE

Your export (seamless **sRGB PNG**) is the right kind of file for every service below — they all want RGB/sRGB (not CMYK) and a seamless tile. **FABRIC** printers take your tile directly; **POD** marketplaces want much bigger files & use their own pattern tools.

SERVICE	TYPE	DPI	COLOUR	FORMATS	NOTES
Spoonflower	Fabric	150	sRGB	PNG / JPG	Upload one seamless tile; it repeats. Downsamples anything above 150 DPI.
Prinfab (UK)	Fabric	180	sRGB, embed ICC	PNG / JPG / TIFF	Upload a single tile; their software repeats it. Repeat preview + Magic Repeat.
Little Cocalico (US)	Fabric	300 (150 min)	RGB	PNG/TIF/JPG/EPS/PDF	Upload at intended print size. Kornit pigment; 2–4 day turnaround.
Fabric on Demand (US)	Fabric	150–300	RGB	PNG / JPG / TIFF	Repeats your tile & won't resize it (half-drop / step / mirror). Base fabric is white — bake in any bg colour.
RealFabric (US/NY)	Fabric	~150–300*	sRGB*	—	File spec not published — use the fabric norm and confirm with them before a large order. Oeko-Tex cotton/silk/poly, no minimums.
Printful	POD (AOP)	150 (300 rec)	sRGB	PNG / JPG, ≤200MB	Per-product templates (AOP tee ≈8640×5460px) + built-in seamless pattern tool.
Redbubble	POD	pixels, not DPI	sRGB	PNG / JPG, ≤13500px	One upload spans all products; ≈7632×6480px ideal for full bleed. Pattern tool.
Society6	POD	300	RGB only	PNG / JPG	Square 12000×12000 recommended (6500×6500 min). CMYK renders inverted.

* RealFabric doesn't publish a clear file spec; the values shown are the safe fabric-printing norm. For any 300-DPI fabric printer, set the export's Output DPI toggle to 300.